

CLASS - 12th

SUBJECT - ENGLISH

PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

CLASS 12TH BIHAR BOARD – ENGLISH (RAINBOW PART 2)

CHAPTER 7: A CHILD IS BORN (BY GERMAINE GREER)

 CHAPTER SUMMARY (IN 50 WORDS)

"A Child is Born" is an insightful essay by Germaine Greer. It explores childbirth and parent-child relationships in traditional societies versus modern Western societies. Greer argues that traditional ways offer greater emotional support, community celebration, and security to mothers, unlike the highly medicalized, isolated Western methods.

 15 IMPORTANT SHORT SUBJECTIVE QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Q1. What is the difference between a traditional birth and a Western birth?

Ans: Traditional birth is a collective family event full of emotional support and rituals, whereas Western birth is a highly medicalized, clinical, and isolated experience.

Q2. How does a pregnant woman in a traditional society feel during pregnancy?

Ans: She feels secure and supported because she is not alone; her family and community share her anxieties and celebrate her journey.

Q3. Why does a Sylheti woman go to her mother's house for the last months of pregnancy?

Ans: She goes to get proper rest, care, and pampering from her own mother, and to escape the heavy domestic workload of her husband's home.

Q4. What is the significance of the 'Rup Thoka' ritual mentioned in the chapter?

Ans: It is a traditional ceremony where the newborn baby and mother are dressed in new clothes, garlanded, and blessed by the community.

Q5. How does the naming ceremony of a child happen in traditional families?

Ans: A naming ceremony is a festive event with a feast, music, and new clothes, where the entire extended family gathers to welcome and name the child.

Q6. What happens to a woman's status when she becomes a mother in traditional societies?

Ans: Her social status rises significantly. She is no longer just a daughter-in-law; she gains respect and authority as the mother of a new family member.



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Q7. Why does Germaine Greer criticize modern Western medical technology in childbirth?

Ans: She criticizes it because it treats childbirth as a disease or technical crisis, ignoring the emotional bond and making the mother feel isolated.

Q8. How does an infant sleep in a traditional home?

Ans: The infant sleeps in the same bed with the parents or close to family members, ensuring warmth, physical contact, and continuous monitoring.

Q9. What are the potential dangers of Westernized hospital births according to the author?

Ans: The dangers include high medical costs, unnecessary surgical interventions, and the emotional trauma of loneliness for both mother and baby.

Q10. Who takes care of the baby in a traditional joint family?

Ans: The entire household, including grandmothers, aunts, and older cousins, shares the responsibility of nursing, feeding, and playing with the baby.

Q11. What does the term "Traditional Society" imply in this chapter?

Ans: It implies communities that rely on ancient cultural practices, extended family structures, and community wisdom rather than technological solutions.

Q12. What problem do non-technological societies face regarding infant health?

Ans: They often face higher infant and maternal mortality rates due to a lack of emergency medical facilities and proper sanitation.

Q13. How does the modernization of childbirth affect women in developing nations?

Ans: It often strips them of their cultural support networks without providing adequate or affordable alternative medical healthcare systems.

Q14. What does the author mean by "the collective wisdom of the family"?

Ans: It refers to the experiential knowledge passed down by elder women regarding pregnancy, child-rearing, remedies, and moral guidance.

Q15. What is the ultimate message of Germaine Greer in this essay?

Ans: The message is that while medical progress is useful, we must protect the human, emotional, and social values associated with welcoming a new life.

50 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS (QUESTION & OPTIONS IN SINGLE LINE)

1. 'A Child is Born' is written by the famous feminist writer: (A) Toru Dutt (B) Pearl S. Buck (C) Germaine Greer (D) George Eliot

2. Germaine Greer is a well-known _____ author.: (A) American (B) Australian (C) British (D) Indian

3. Germaine Greer was born in the year: (A) 1919 (B) 1929 (C) 1939 (D) 1949



CLASS - 12th SUBJECT - ENGLISH PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

4. The chapter 'A Child is Born' is an extract from her famous book: (A) The Female Eunuch (B) Sex and Destiny (C) The Change (D) Daddy
5. In traditional societies, childbirth is primarily a _____ affair.: (A) personal (B) political (C) family/collective (D) commercial
6. In Western societies, childbirth has become completely: (A) medicalized (B) banned (C) neglected (D) open-air
7. A pregnant woman in traditional societies faces pregnancy with: (A) absolute terror (B) total isolation (C) confidence and security (D) indifference
8. A Sylheti woman goes to live with her _____ for childbirth.: (A) mother-in-law (B) own mother (C) sister (D) friend
9. She stays at her mother's house for the last _____ months of pregnancy.: (A) two (B) three (C) five (D) eight
10. At her mother's place, the pregnant woman enjoys a lot of: (A) hard work (B) scolding (C) care and pampering (D) loneliness
11. When the baby is born, the event is celebrated by the whole: (A) army (B) neighborhood/family (C) nation (D) world
12. In Bangladesh, children are cared for by the whole: (A) state (B) hospital staff (C) joint family (D) boarding school
13. On the _____ day of birth, the naming ceremony is held.: (A) first (B) third (C) seventh (D) thirtieth
14. During the ceremony, the mother gets beautiful new: (A) cars (B) clothes and sweets (C) books (D) tools
15. In traditional cultures, a woman loses her own name and is known by her child's name after: (A) marriage (B) graduation (C) motherhood (D) old age
16. The Western method of birth isolates the mother in a sterile: (A) forest (B) hospital room (C) theater (D) market
17. The author points out that Western women find childbirth to be a _____ experience.: (A) highly celebratory (B) lonely and mechanical (C) romantic (D) non-medical
18. Infant mortality rates are usually higher in _____ societies.: (A) wealthy (B) Western (C) non-technological/traditional (D) European
19. Germaine Greer argues that technology has made birth a clinical: (A) joy (B) joke (C) crisis/disease (D) sport
20. In South Africa, the pregnant woman's family sings songs to offer: (A) money (B) psychological support (C) food (D) warning
21. Modern hospital setups often ignore the mother's need for emotional: (A) cash (B) warmth and dignity (C) medicine (D) politics
22. The relationship between mother and child in traditional areas is highly: (A) distant (B) intimate and continuous (C) business-like (D) hostile



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23. The ritual baths given to the mother are symbols of: (A) punishment (B) purification and renewal (C) play (D) medical tests
24. In the West, a husband is often the only person allowed to support his wife, leading to: (A) heavy crowd (B) high pressure and isolation (C) celebrations (D) dance
25. Breastfeeding is universally promoted in traditional setups as a natural: (A) burden (B) duty and health booster (C) medication (D) fashion
26. "A Child is Born" presents a comparative study of: (A) East and West (B) past and future (C) rich and poor (D) youth and age
27. Traditional midwives rely heavily on ancestral: (A) textbooks (B) machinery (C) practical experience and intuition (D) internet
28. The author states that child rearing in the West is an individual: (A) game (B) nightmare/burden (C) achievement (D) business
29. In traditional families, grandmothers act as natural: (A) enemies (B) guides and babysitters (C) doctors (D) masters
30. The primary purpose of the essay is to critique modern medicalization of: (A) old age (B) human life/birth (C) education (D) sports
31. The author notes that in traditional systems, the woman's workload during pregnancy is: (A) doubled (B) reduced (C) ignored (D) continuous
32. The naming ceremony features songs sung by the household's: (A) men (B) women (C) children (D) priests
33. Western childbirth experiences are often driven by fear of medical: (A) awards (B) lawsuits and complications (C) crowds (D) costs
34. Non-technological societies accept pain as a natural part of: (A) sin (B) life and birth (C) machine (D) medicine
35. The child's arrival stabilizes the mother's position in her husband's: (A) office (B) house/clan (C) mind (D) country
36. Greer believes that modern doctors often behave like omnipotent: (A) friends (B) gods/authorities (C) servants (D) students
37. Traditional childcare allows the mother to resume her work: (A) immediately (B) gradually with family help (C) never (D) alone
38. The title "A Child is Born" emphasizes the collective joy of welcoming: (A) wealth (B) new human life (C) computers (D) weapons
39. The author's language in the essay is sharp, analytical, and: (A) confusing (B) feminist/critical (C) romantic (D) poetic
40. Many traditional practices are technically hygienic but rich in: (A) poison (B) emotional value (C) currency (D) stress
41. In the West, babies are often kept in separate rooms called: (A) stables (B) nurseries/cribs (C)



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lounges (D) kitchens

42. Traditional societies look at pregnancy as a normal physiological: (A) illness (B) state of being (C) mistake (D) trade

43. The author calls out the clinical arrogance of modern: (A) farmers (B) obstetricians/medical systems (C) teachers (D) poets

44. The essay suggests that human connection is vital for the baby's: (A) financial growth (B) emotional development (C) clothing (D) schooling

45. In Sylhet, the newborn baby is visited by all female: (A) enemies (B) relatives and neighbors (C) officers (D) buyers

46. The mother's dietary needs during pregnancy are carefully managed by family: (A) rules (B) elders (C) books (D) laws

47. The modern Western style of parenting increases maternal: (A) peace (B) depression and anxiety (C) wealth (D) strength

48. Greer argues that a child shouldn't be treated as a mere: (A) human (B) property/clinical object (C) gift (D) joy

49. Traditional birth practices have been tested over many: (A) days (B) generations (C) hours (D) weeks

50. "A Child is Born" is an essential piece in the study of gender and: (A) economics (B) culture/healthcare (C) geography (D) mathematics

WHERE EXCELLENCE IS
TRADITION

SUJIT KUMAR

